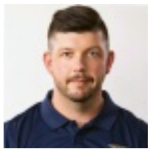
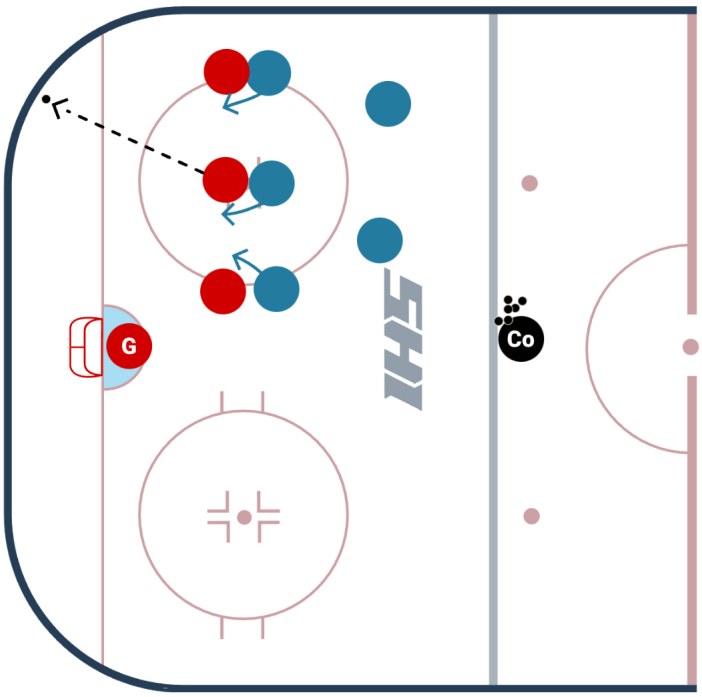
POWER PLAY FACE-OFF LOSS DRILL



Time: **Station:**



Power Play Faceoff Loss Retrieval Drill from Wes Wolfe simulates a common game scenario: your power play unit loses a faceoff, and they must quickly retrieve the puck before the penalty killers clear it. It emphasizes puck retrieval, inside body positioning, and efficient puck movement to maintain offensive pressure.

Setup:

- **Power Play Alignment:** Position your power play unit as they would be for a typical faceoff (e.g., traditional set or four up).
- **Penalty Killers:** Place three opposing players to simulate a penalty kill. Their objective is to slow down the power play but not actively clear or play the puck.
- **Coach:** Position the coach with pucks near the blue line.

Execution:

1. **Start the Drill:** The coach spots a puck into the corner as if the penalty kill has won the faceoff. Penalty killers focus on slowing the power play players as they attempt to retrieve the puck.
2. **Puck Retrieval:** Power play players work to bump and jump into inside body position to win back the puck. Encourage quick puck retrieval and immediate release to teammates to set up a play.
3. **Shot Creation:** Once possession is regained, the power play unit is encouraged to take no more than three passes before generating their first shot.
4. **Follow-Up:** After the initial shot, the coach spots a second puck (e.g., on a rim) to work on rim retrievals. Play continues live, allowing the power play unit to transition quickly into a scoring opportunity.

Progressions:

- Transition from a 5-on-0 setup to live scenarios:
  - **5-on-3:** Introduce full-pressure penalty killing to simulate game intensity.
  - **5-on-4:** Add defenders and play live.
  - **5-on-0:** Focus solely on puck movement and structure without defensive pressure.
- Adjust pressure from the penalty killers to focus on specific skills like puck retrieval or quick puck movement.

Key Teaching Points:

- Emphasize winning inside body position to regain control of the puck.
- Teach players to react quickly to lost faceoffs and prevent the penalty kill from clearing the puck.
- Focus on efficiency: retrieve, pass, and generate a shot within three passes.
- Reinforce habits that prevent wasted time or lost opportunities after a faceoff loss.

Variation:

- Adjust the alignment or defensive pressure based on your team's level. Incorporate different puck spotting techniques (e.g., rimmed, bouncing) to simulate game-like retrieval challenges.

View more content from Wes on his contributor page along with his presentation on Special Teams Practice at the Brock University High Performance Hockey Conference.